

Network faxing

Though quite comprehensive, Microsoft Fax lacks features such as network faxing. You will need powerful software such as Symantec's WinFax PRO 10.0.

The setup is straightforward. Once it's complete, the first screen asks you to enter the CSID (called station identification), your fax number and your phone number. The second screen asks you to choose modems and other devices that you want WinFax PRO to use to send faxes. Next, the chosen modem is tested to determine speed and other parameters. Once this is done, specify whether you want to put WinFax PRO controller in the Windows Startup. You can receive faxes via e-mail by enabling that option in the next screen. All you need to do is choose the e-mail program and enter the password.

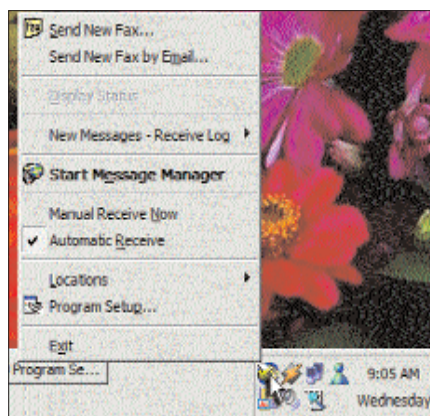
If you wish to skip the registration step, click on Cancel. Finally, the Live Update starts to update WinFax PRO—this can also be skipped by clicking on Cancel. That's it!

Sending a fax

Bring up the WinFax PRO Message Manager—the centre point for all of your fax related tasks—by going to **Start > Programs > Symantec WinFax PRO > WinFax PRO Message Manager**. Go to **Send > Send New Fax...**, or click Send on the toolbar to bring up the WinFax PRO dialog box. Here, click on an address book entry to insert the name and fax number, or enter them manually, and then click on Add to List. Also, schedule the send time for individual recipients by clicking on Schedule. Next, to create a cover page, choose '(Other...)' from the drop-down list that's located just below the subject field, to bring up the 'Select Cover page' dialog box. Choose from the many pre-defined templates here and add the note and the

subject that appears on the fax's cover page. Finally, click Send to send the fax.

You can view the status of the fax—whether it failed or was sent successfully—by clicking Send Log in the Message Manager. If you want to send a fax as an e-mail, click Send on the Message Manager window to bring up the Send dialog box. Here, click Email on the toolbar. A new dialog box opens where you specify the address of the fax recipient, the subject and the message. Next, click Insert to insert files and click on Send when you are done. This fax will be sent the next time you open your e-mail client. The advantage of sending a fax to e-mail is that your Word files, etc., can be viewed by anyone, even those who don't have Word installed, and secondly, it goes in an unalterable format. When you send fax to e-mail, it is sent as a self-executing file that can be viewed on any Windows PC.

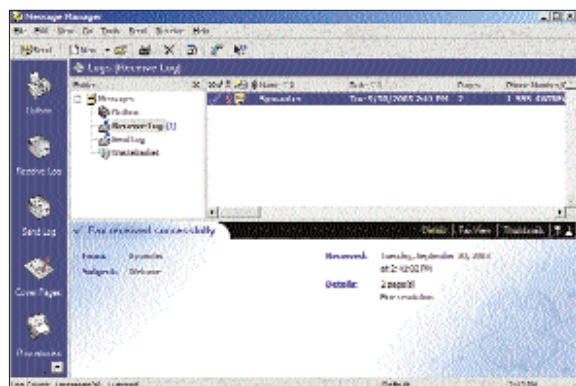


Right-click the fax icon to access the most common functions of WinFax PRO

Receiving a fax

Check whether automated fax receiving is enabled by right-clicking the fax icon in your System Tray to show the controller menu.

If 'Automatic Receive' is enabled, faxes will be received automatically. If it is unchecked, you will have to right-click the System Tray fax icon, and click 'Manual Receive Now' or go to **Receive > Manual Receive Now** in the Message Manager window to receive the fax. You can customise the fax receiving settings even further by going to **Start > Programs > Symantec WinFax PRO > Program Setup > Receive** and then selecting Properties.



Message Manager is the control centre for all operation related to WinFax PRO

Setting up a Fax Server

WinFax PRO can be setup on a network in an organisation such that PCs send their fax jobs to one computer that acts as a fax server. This lets you use a single modem and a phone line. To set up the WinFax PRO server, run the setup and then go to **Start > Programs > Symantec WinFax PRO > Program Setup**. Click on Fax Sharing Host, select Properties and check 'Use this WinFax PRO station as a Fax Sharing Host'. You may also specify a password here, so that only authenticated users can access the fax server. Click OK, and then click Close.

On the client PCs, when you come to the Modems And Communications Devices panel in the Configuration Wizard, click WinFax PRO Fax Sharing and click Next. Click Yes to configure the WinFax PRO Fax Sharing device. In the WinFax PRO Fax Sharing Client Properties dialog box, enter the name of the fax sharing server in the Host Name section. Enter the password, if it exists. The rest of the steps are similar to the normal installation. Now, when a fax is sent from the client machine, it goes to the server and is sent automatically.

Use the options in the General tab to specify the number of rings after which the call should be answered. Specify the time when you want calls to be answered automatically by clicking on Schedule. Decide the action that has to be taken after a fax is received, such as playing a sound or printing it in the 'After Receive' tab. In the 'Junk Fax' tab, you can specify what to do with junk faxes—faxes with a missing or incorrect CSID.

In fact, there are lots of features that can be customised in WinFax PRO. For this, you will have to go to the Program Setup located in the **Start > Programs > Symantec WinFax PRO** group. Here, you will find options such as backing up and restoring your faxes and logs.

That's the way you get your PC to double up as fax machine. You can also try setting it up using faxing software that comes with its modem driver installation CD. These software have made faxing very easy and less of a tedious job to do. So, the next time the boss needs to send things urgently, all you have to do is use the PC! ■

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